MENT 2234: Midterm Project Instructions

Course weight and deadlines

Blogs 10%; simulation reflections 40%; participation 10%; midterm report and video together 20%; final report and video together 20%. Team registration is required setup with no separate course weight. Preserve the existing Blackboard allocation between each report and video; use the video scoring criteria already posted there. Report rubric points (midterm 60 plus up to 4 bonus; final 50) are not course percentages. All existing Blackboard deadlines and cutoff times remain unchanged.

For the midterm, your team will analyze a company through four entrepreneurship topics and share your findings in a written report and a **15-minute pitch video**. Use evidence, course concepts, and reflections from your simulation experience to explain your conclusions.

Project overview

You will develop **one shared report about one company across two submissions**. The two report rubrics contain **110 raw points in total, with up to 4 bonus points available on the midterm**. Each project keeps its separate 20% course weight; do not calculate the course grade by pooling the 110 report points.

Submission	Report points	Report sections	Submission process
Part 1: Midterm	60 points + up to 4 bonus points	A–D	The Team Leader downloads and uploads a PDF of the completed midterm report.
Part 2: Final	50 points	A–E	SkillSimm captures the report as a final PDF when the Team Leader submits.

The requirements below cover Part 1. See the Final Project Instructions for Part 2 and the Midterm Schedule and Instructions for the class schedule.

Choose your company

Select **one of the following four companies** before you begin writing, and use that company for both the midterm and final. Your analysis should connect course concepts to the company's specific challenges, decisions, and opportunities.

Company	Possible areas of focus	Research starting points
SpaceX	Capital needs, government customers such as NASA and the Department of Defense, Starlink as an internal venture, and launch scheduling risks	Company materials and available SEC filings. Check EDGAR for SpaceX to confirm whether an S-1 filing sequence is available.
Affirm	Consumer lending regulation, merchant concentration, credit-loss disclosures, and the company's "no late fees" positioning	The S-1 and amendments associated with its January 2021 IPO, the final prospectus, and subsequent annual reports.
Stripe	Payment infrastructure, internal ventures such as Atlas and Climate, data protection, and financing strategy	Company annual letters, funding and tender announcements, policy documents, and public partner materials. Check EDGAR for any available registration filings.
Anthropic	The relationship between social mission and commercial goals, AI safety, and governance	Published policies, the Responsible Scaling Policy, public benefit corporation and Long-Term Benefit Trust materials, funding announcements, and any available registration filings.

Affirm is the recommended choice because its IPO filing sequence provides a useful foundation for comparing disclosures over time. You are welcome to choose another company if your team has a strong interest in it and can identify sufficient evidence.

Before confirming your choice, check the availability of filings in SEC EDGAR. If your chosen company does not have an S-1 sequence, plan to use company publications, relevant regulatory materials, and reputable reporting. Clearly explain any limitations, including whether audited public financial statements are available.

Midterm report: 60 points + up to 4 bonus points

Organize Part 1 of your report into the following four sections.

A. Sweets and Bitterness Analysis — 15 points + up to 2 bonus points

Explore the rewards and challenges of the entrepreneurial journey.

1. Describe the entrepreneurial challenges and rewards associated with your chosen company.
2. Analyze the personal and professional trade-offs entrepreneurs face.
3. Reflect on how your simulation experiences connect to the entrepreneurial journey.
4. **Bonus:** Up to 2 points are available for insightful personal reflection.

B. Ethical and Legal Framework — 15 points

1. Identify the ethical standards relevant to your chosen company.
2. Analyze the legal requirements the company needs to meet.
3. Evaluate privacy, security, and data protection considerations.
4. Propose governance systems that support ethical decision-making.

C. Corporate Entrepreneurship Assessment — 15 points + up to 2 bonus points

Corporate entrepreneurship, or intrapreneurship, involves developing new ideas and ventures within an existing organization.

1. Analyze intrapreneurial opportunities within your chosen company.
2. Evaluate organizational structures that support innovation.
3. Assess how resources are secured and allocated to support new initiatives.
4. **Bonus:** Up to 2 points are available for a comprehensive analysis.

D. Social Entrepreneurship Evaluation — 15 points

1. Define the company's social mission and the problems it seeks to address.
2. Analyze hybrid business model approaches that combine social and commercial goals.
3. Evaluate methods for measuring social impact.
4. Assess strategies for maintaining financial sustainability.

Midterm pitch video: 15 minutes

Record and submit a team pitch video that covers the following four areas. Present your analysis clearly and connect your conclusions to the company you selected.

A. Sweets and Bitterness of Entrepreneurs

1. Describe the potential ups and downs for your chosen company.
2. Discuss the company's entrepreneurial story and journey.
3. Analyze the trade-offs its entrepreneurs face.

B. Ethical and Legal Standards

1. Identify relevant ethical and legal standards.
2. Evaluate how well the company follows those standards.
3. Recommend areas for improvement.

C. Corporate Entrepreneurship Analysis

1. Assess intrapreneurial activities within the organization.
2. Evaluate resource allocation for internal ventures.
3. Analyze organizational support for innovation.

D. Social Entrepreneurship Impact

1. Identify the social or environmental problems the company addresses.
2. Evaluate the balance between its social mission and financial sustainability.
3. Assess its approaches to measuring impact.

Working together and submitting your report

Your five-person team will work in **one shared Google Doc** throughout the project. Write Part 1 first; later, add Part 2 below it in the same document. Use team chat to discuss ideas, coordinate revisions, and resolve differences before changing one another's work.

Team role	Midterm responsibility
Member 1	Section A: Sweets and Bitterness Analysis
Member 2	Section B: Ethical and Legal Framework
Member 3	Section C: Corporate Entrepreneurship Assessment
Member 4	Section D: Social Entrepreneurship Evaluation
Team Leader	Review, integrate, and submit the completed report

Team members

Complete your assigned section in the shared document, then submit your individual task in SkillSimm. Include a brief, accurate summary of your contribution. Edits in the shared document may appear as "Anonymous," so this summary is used to record your individual contribution.

Team Leader

Your submission task unlocks after all four members have submitted their tasks.

1. Read the full report and bring the sections together into a clear, cohesive document.
2. Coordinate any remaining edits and confirm that the report is ready for grading.
3. **Download the completed midterm report as a PDF and upload it** for the midterm submission.

The uploaded PDF is the version that will be graded. Submitting it also unlocks Part 2. You will continue revising the shared document after receiving feedback, so this separate PDF preserves your midterm submission.

Research and sources

SEC filings: compare the filing sequence

Use SEC EDGAR to find available filings. When an IPO filing sequence is available, collect the initial **S-1**, its **S-1/A amendments**, and the **424B4 final prospectus**. The number of amendments may vary.

Compare consecutive versions and look for changes in:

- **Financial information:** revised figures, additional reporting periods, or changes to non-GAAP definitions.
- **Risk disclosures:** risks that were added, clarified, or given greater emphasis.
- **Business descriptions:** changes in how the company describes its activities and strategy.
- **Customer concentration:** new or more detailed information about reliance on particular customers.

Explain what the changes suggest and support your interpretation with evidence. Avoid assuming that a change resulted from SEC or underwriter pressure unless your sources establish that connection. These comparisons can strengthen your midterm analysis of legal compliance, governance, and financial sustainability, as well as your final analysis of risks and growth strategies.

Other useful filings include **10-K annual reports**, **10-Q quarterly reports**, **8-K current reports**, and **DEF 14A proxy statements**, which can provide information about governance, board structure, and compensation.

Alumni interviews

UConn NetWerx can help you connect with alumni. Interviews can add firsthand perspectives on entrepreneurial rewards, challenges, and trade-offs. Obtain consent, take careful notes, and attribute interview insights appropriately in your report.

Additional evidence

Consider company annual letters, policy and engineering blogs, transparency reports, and governance documents. Consult relevant regulatory and industry materials, such as consumer lending requirements for Affirm, aviation and export-control requirements for SpaceX, payment security standards for Stripe, and AI policy frameworks for Anthropic.

Reputable business reporting can help document funding rounds and valuations. Cite the outlet and publication date, and distinguish reported valuations from audited financial information. Cite your sources throughout the report so readers can follow your evidence.

Submission checklist

- Confirm the existing deadline and report/video submission entries in Blackboard.

- Complete all report sections and the 15-minute video, with traceable sources.
- Complete the four members' SkillSimm tasks and the Team Leader's submission workflow above.
- Save the report PDF and video; complete the existing Blackboard submission steps for both deliverables and check the submission receipts.
- Use Blackboard's existing report/video allocation and posted video scoring criteria. This guide does not create a new split.